

Exploratory RAISD research fit

Evidence and contestability for AI-mediated public information

For discussion with the RAISD team. No collaboration, consortium, or grant proposal is implied.

Proposed fit

Could RAISD use the Charter's provenance, evidence, challenge, and correction requirements as one testable layer in empirical research on AI-mediated public information?

Can public-facing foundation models represent contested democratic questions in ways that are source-grounded, uncertainty-aware, comparable across languages and model configurations, and meaningfully open to correction?

RAISD combines UZH's Social Computing Group with AlgorithmWatch CH to study how AI affects Swiss society, public debate, and opinion formation through data collection, technical and social-science research, and open-source tools. **Our AI Charter** asks what people and institutions should be able to inspect when they rely on AI: sources and provenance, known limits, responsibility, challenge routes, and evidence of correction.

A study could test those requirements through repeated multilingual evaluations on public Swiss civic material, comparing prompts, retrieval settings, languages, model versions, and correction attempts. This would complement RAISD's work rather than define its agenda. The Charter contributes draft questions and evidence requirements - not a proven method, operating network, or certification system.

Possible roles

Possible contributor	Bounded contribution - subject to interest, agreement, and resourcing
UZH academic team	Scientific leadership; design; compute plan; datasets; ethics; analysis and publication.
RAISD / AlgorithmWatch CH	Swiss democracy and public-sphere framing; platform-audit and social-science expertise; public communication.
FactHarbor / Our AI Charter	Co-design testable evidence and correction requirements; contribute a minimal evidence-record profile; support open documentation.

For a Swiss AI Initiative Large Projects application, the scientific lead must be an eligible researcher at a Swiss public academic or research institution. Prof. Anikó Hannák, an Associate Professor at UZH and a RAISD member, is the clearest publicly verified academic anchor. AlgorithmWatch CH coordinates RAISD but could participate only as an additional partner under the Large Projects rules. The team would decide any structure.

A bounded research package

1. An openly documented multilingual evaluation corpus, protocol, and reproducible harness.
2. An empirical analysis of recurring failure and correction patterns, with versioned evidence records.
3. A public methods and policy note stating what the results do - and do not - support.

Success means reproducible findings and usable evidence - not a claim that a model is neutral, safe, compliant, or certified.

Funding is a vehicle, not the premise

The **Swiss AI Initiative** holds large-project calls twice yearly for requests above **500,000 GPU hours** and accepts small-project applications up to **32,000 GPU hours** continuously. The current fourth call names AI and democratic processes; its Declaration of Intent is due **24 August 2026 at 17:00 CEST**, and the full proposal **14 September 2026 at 17:00 CEST**.

This note establishes neither a >500,000-hour compute case nor Call-4 readiness. A compute route should be considered only after the academic team identifies a justified need. The grants provide compute, not partner funding; under the Large Projects rules, an NGO partner may neither request nor access the resources. Substantial FactHarbor work would require a separate, proportionate scope and resourcing agreement.

Decision to explore: Would this layer dock usefully with RAISD's work? If so, first narrow the research question, the smallest credible demonstrator, and the partner boundary. Funding comes afterward.

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